

GREEN Shoots

| By Malini Bhupta |

Playing their part in the Save Earth mission, young Indian companies are exploring cost-effective technologies to create sources of clean energy

Protecting the earth is not just everybody's business today but is also getting to be big business. Given that the world is still trying to crack how to green the planet at prices that don't burn a hole in the pocket, there is an immense opportunity for young Indian companies in this space. Be it generating power from biomass or fuelling automobiles with biofuels, there is money to be made the clean way as many young entrepreneurs are discovering. With India announcing its biofuels policy late last year, many are engaged in cultivation of plants like jatropha across barren stretches of land, while others are developing water heaters that run on solar power. While the going has not been good as the urgency has not yet built up in India, green warriors are preparing for the big battle ahead. And making neat profits while doing so.

THEIR PLACE IN THE SUN

COMPANY Nuetech Solar Systems | **WHAT THEY DO** Produce Solar Water Heaters | **TURNOVER** Rs 25 crore

Brought up in rural Karnataka, Surendra Kumar, 43, is not new to the vagaries of power supply in his state. So when he was scouting around for a business opportunity, he chose to focus on the renewable energy space. In 1992, when Kumar and his associates decided to set up Nuetch Solar Systems in Bangalore to manufacture solar water heaters, all they faced was resistance, and suffered losses.

Today their belief in the clean technology sector has paid off, as any venture that saves energy is in a "sweet spot". After installing over 15 lakh litres worth of solar water heaters and having saved 75,000 units (kWh) of electricity, the company has come a long way. Nuetch claims that a household saves approximately 40 to 60 per cent of its electricity bill after switching over to a solar water heater. Unlike traditional solar water heaters, Nuetch's water heaters use evacuated solar technology. From manufacturing four heaters a day, the company's new manufacturing facility has a capacity of 1,500 units per month. State government incentives have helped. Says Kumar: "Today, the state mandates all new buildings to install a solar water heater. This has given a boost."



NUETECH CLAIMS THAT SWITCHING TO SOLAR WATER HEATERS CAN SAVE BETWEEN 40 AND 60 PER CENT OF ELECTRICITY BILL